

The Bird and The Branches

You play as a bird (a symbol to shadow in Jungian psychology) to interact with the world (the suppress conscious)



Denial Stage

Each tree will attempt to snap back as soon as a bird lands on a branch. Once the bird has surveyed all five trees, it will turn into anger stage.

The stage features inverted controls, and Button Mashing mode where players must rapidly press buttons to prevent the bird from falling into the abyss

Anger Stage

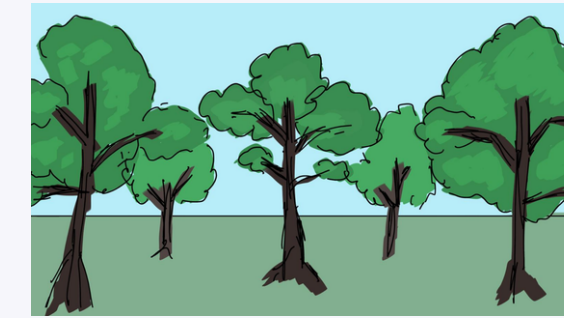


Bargaining Stage

During this stage, trees that were once upright bend, with flickering lights inside. Players must use inverted controls to touch all five flickering lights on the trees.

It started to rain, and bird began falling from the sky. Now players can only walk and jump. Player can also use shadows to hug the trees. After hugging all trees, it will unlock an interaction to lie down next to a tree.

Depression Stage

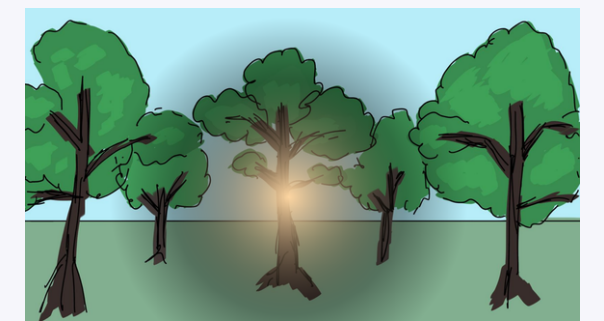


Acceptance Stage

The world begins to brighten. By now, inverted controls are completely gone. Players can explore the world freely. The bird can fly again. After interacting with five trees and returning to the central tree, a final interaction, Merging, will appear

After choosing Merging, the bird will grow larger and larger before transforming into a light that illuminates and becomes a part of this world.

Individuation Ending



Character Design

The player takes on the role of a bird exploring an inner world that is attempting to suppress its own emotions.

I chose a bird as a symbol of the Jungian Shadow because the shadow is not easily contained. It is always flying and moving within us.

Visual Identity

- The bird is based on a bald eagle, but it is rendered in a solid, pitch-black color with no facial features to directly reflect the nature of a shadow.
- The edges are diffused, making the bird appear like a lingering shadow in the mind rather than a solid, physical object.



Denial Stage

Stage Detailed Breakdown



This is the beginning of the game. Players will explore a world with five trees. Each tree will attempt to snap back as soon as a bird lands on a branch, creating an echo.

Once a bird has explored all five trees, and each tree has interacted with at least three times, the scene will turn to the anger stage.

Control Instability: Input Lag

As soon as the bird is flicked by the tree, the delay temporarily increases.

Stage Detailed Breakdown

The game introduces inverted controls; as the player gets used to these incorrect maneuvers, holes appear in the ground. The system then switches to "Button Mashing" mode, where the player must rapidly press buttons to prevent the bird from falling into the abyss, symbolizing the struggle against intense anger.

Control Instability: Inverted Controls

In addition to inverted controls, the bird's body vibrates due to the uncontrollable emotions of the world, causing it to fly in a non-straight line.



Anger Stage

Bargaining Stage

Stage Detailed Breakdown



The trees begin to bend, symbolizing pleas and supplications, like a bowing gesture. Each tree has flickering light orb. This symbolizes a life-threatening condition that is nearing its end and requires CPR as a final bargaining. Players must collect all the light orbs to pass this stage.

Control Instability: Timing Bar

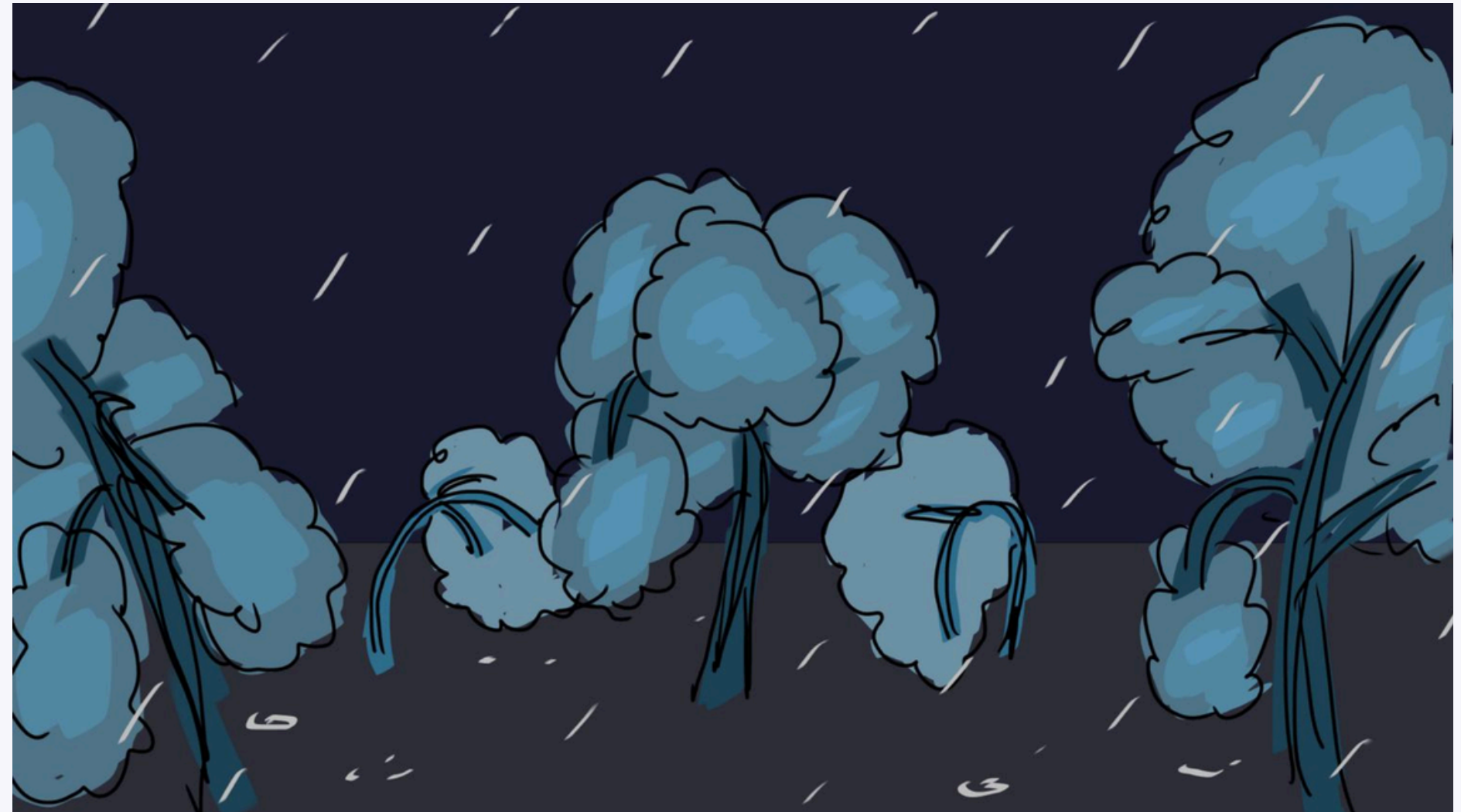
To collect each light orb, the player must perform CPR by pressing the timing bar at the right moment. However, it will speeds up, making it impossible to hit the orb, forcing the player to fail.

Stage Detailed Breakdown

It started to rain, and bird began falling from the sky. Now players can only walk and jump. This stage unlocks a new interaction: hugging the tree. This represents the bird, a shadow, wanting to embrace the tree to comfort its sorrow. But no matter how many times it hugs, the tree will dispel the shadow. When the player hugs all five trees, it unlocks the interaction of lying beside a tree, symbolizing staying by its side until the rain stops.

Control Instability: Sticky Movement

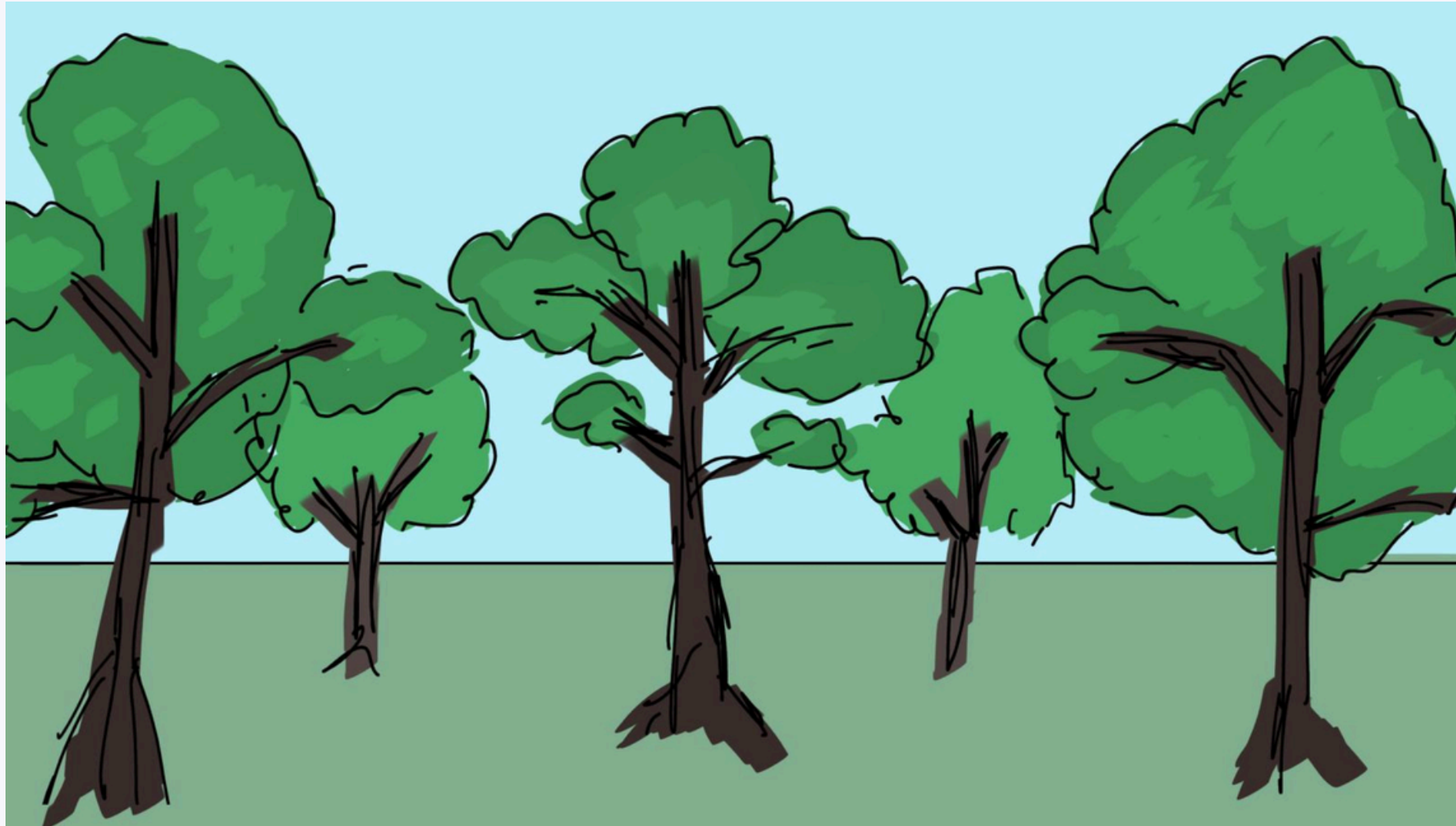
Players can no longer fly, and walking will feel like walking in mud. Jumping will be heavy and they will land very quickly.



Depression Stage

Acceptance Stage

Stage Detailed Breakdown



The world begins to brighten. By now, inverted controls are completely gone. Players can explore the world freely. The bird can fly again. After interacting with five trees and returning to the central tree, a final interaction, Merging, will appear

No More Control Instability

Stage Detailed Breakdown

After choosing Merging, the bird will grow larger and larger before transforming into a light that illuminates and becomes a part of this world.

This is the process of individuation according to Karl Jung's theory, which states that achieving complete selfhood involves accepting one's own shadow.

The End



Individuation Ending